READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14–26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.*

The problem of graffiti

Is it art? Or is it a crime?

A The term 'graffiti' derives from the Italian word *graffio* meaning 'scratching', and can be defined as uninvited markings or writing scratched or applied to objects, built structures, and natural features. It is not a new phenomenon; examples can be found on ancient structures around the world, in some cases predating the Greeks and Romans. In such circumstances, it has acquired invaluable historical and archaeological significance as it provides a social history of life and events at that time. This is not true of more recent graffiti, which has become a pervasive problem particularly over the last 50 years, as a result of the availability of cheap and quick means of mark-making. These include the ubiquitous spray paints.

B Graffitists, the people who are responsible for creating graffiti, are indiscriminate about the surfaces they choose. Wherever graffiti appears, it is usually considered a priority to remove it as quickly as possible. One reason for this is to prevent 'copy-cat' emulation, which can occur rapidly once a clean surface is defaced, and so many companies and councils have a policy of removing graffiti within an hour or two of it being reported. Another reason is that as paints, glues, and inks dry out, they can become increasingly difficult to remove. A more important factor, however, is that graffiti can lead to more serious forms of vandalism and, ultimately, to the deterioration of a neighborhood area, and in this way contributes to a general social decline. For this reason, the police like to be notified of new graffiti incidents. To aid in achieving a successful prosecution, they encourage owners of properties to take photographs of any new graffiti, as there could be other related incidents occurring locally. An incidence pattern can help to identify possible culprits, as can their 'tag'—the distinctive mark graffitists leave to show the graffiti is their work.

C Any proposal to remove graffiti has to be carefully considered because techniques designed for robust or utilitarian surfaces may result in considerable damage to older, more historic buildings. Consequently, as no two sites are the same, there is no one treatment which will be suitable for all situations; each site must be looked at individually. The owners of some graffiti-affected sites may wish to attempt their own treatment, whereas others may prefer to contact a specialist contractor. However, whichever course is decided on, it is important to follow a systematic approach. The first step is to carry out cleaning trials to see which method is suitable for the removal of the graffiti media used, and also which method has the least impact on the site surface. These trials should be carried out on a small unobtrusive area if possible and should

always start with the least aggressive cleaning method, usually water, and stop once a successful method has been found.

D Apart from water, a variety of methods can be used to remove graffiti; broadly, these are divided into chemical and mechanical systems. When using either of these systems, care must be taken with regard to protecting both passers-by and the person carrying out the graffiti removal. Chemical preparations are based on dissolving the graffiti media; these solvents can range from mild to potentially dangerous chemical 'cocktails'. When using chemicals, it is important to wear protective clothing, take measures to minimize any run-off of potentially harmful chemicals, and avoid the drifting of aerial mists. Mechanical systems are often in the form of wire-brushing and grit blasting, which attempt to chip off the graffiti media. Operators of mechanical systems must also wear protective clothing to avoid being hurt by hard airborne particles. This method often leaves marks on a surface.

E Different measures can be adopted to combat a recurring problem of graffiti. It is clear that protection measures will ultimately be more successful and less damaging than multiple removal treatments. Popular places for graffiti are often readily accessible flat surfaces where the graffiti will have an instant impact, but this is not always the case, and graffitists may scale bridges to give their work greater prominence. Possible protection measures may include a combination of floodlighting to illuminate dark areas and surveillance systems such as closed-circuit television. Research has shown that prominently placed cameras can reduce the incidence of graffiti in areas with a recurring problem. Unfortunately, the cost of any of these measures may be too high, and so physical obstacles such as fences, railings, doors, or gates can be introduced to discourage unauthorized access, though in some cases, these obstacles simply provide a new surface for graffiti.

F Another strategy is to apply a removable anti-graffiti barrier-coating as a form of preventive measure. Although this will not stop graffiti being applied, it will make its removal much easier and usually only involves using water, which reduces the possibility of damage to the site surface. Barrier coatings are usually applied by brush or spray, leaving a thin veneer that essentially serves to isolate the graffiti from the surface. So, although there is no prescription for dealing with every graffiti incident, there are some steps that can be taken to minimize the impact of graffiti and to protect vulnerable surfaces.

Questions 14 - 18

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs, ***A–F****.*

Which paragraph contains the following information?

Write the correct letter, ***A–F****, in boxes 14-18 on your answer sheet.*

NB *You may use any letter more than once.*

14 A suggestion that might assist in bringing an effective legal action against graffitists

15 An explanation why all instances of graffiti cannot be removed in the same way

16 An argument that graffiti can have a negative effect on community life

17 An admission that some strategies for tackling graffiti may lead to an increase in graffiti

18 Some risks people face when graffiti is being removed

Questions 19 and 20

Choose ***TWO*** *letters,* ***A–E****.*

Write the correct letters in boxes 19 and 20 on your answer sheet.

The article gives details about different methods of removing graffiti.

Which **TWO** points are made by the writer of this article?

- **A** Chemicals are an expensive method of removing graffiti from surfaces.
- **B** An inconspicuous part of a surface should be used to test a cleaning method.
- **C** Alcohol-based chemical preparations are often successful at removing graffiti.
- **D** Localised pollution can result from some cleaning methods.
- **E** It is best to use the strongest available cleaning method.

Questions 21 and 22

*Choose **TWO** letters, **A–E**.*

Write the correct letters in boxes 21 and 22 on your answer sheet.

The writer describes ways of combating a recurring problem of graffiti.

Which **TWO** of these ideas are mentioned by the writer?

A Running advertising campaigns against graffiti
B Creating a new building material that repels graffiti
C Hiring security guards and increasing police patrols
D Ensuring surfaces are visible and monitored both day and night
E Adding a covering layer that graffiti cannot penetrate

Questions 23 - 26

Complete the sentences below.

*Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 23-26 on your answer sheet.

23 Ancient graffiti is studied because it records a _____ of the culture of that period.

24 The unique signature of graffitists, known as a _____, can assist police in finding and prosecuting them.

25 Operators of both chemical and mechanical graffiti removal systems must have _____.

26 Surfaces treated with a barrier-coating can normally be cleaned with _____.

Disclaimer
Compiled, formatted, and lightly proofread by ZYZ Reading Walks.
All copyright in the underlying works remains with the original authors and publishers.
No affiliation with or endorsement by any rights holder (including IELTS® owners).
For non-commercial educational use only. This notice must remain intact in all copies.
Available free of charge from ZYZ Reading Walks. Resale or any paid distribution is prohibited.

Questions 14–18

段落信息配对题

题号	答案	题干翻译	精确定位句	定位句翻译	详细解释
14	**B**	一项可能有助于**对涂鸦者提起有效法律诉讼**的建议	**“To aid in achieving a successful prosecution, they encourage owners of properties to take photographs of any new graffiti ...”**	“为了帮助成功起诉，警方鼓励物业所有者给任何新的涂鸦拍照……”	题干关键词是 **effective legal action against graffitists**，对应原文里的 **successful prosecution**（成功起诉）。这是非常直接的同义替换。并且原文说的“拍照”就是一种**建议**，所以答案在 **B 段**。
15	**C**	解释为什么**所有涂鸦情况不能用同一种方式清除**	**“...as no two sites are the same, there is no one treatment which will be suitable for all situations; each site must be looked at individually.”**	“由于没有两个地点是完全一样的，因此不存在一种适用于所有情况的处理方法：每个地点都必须单独考察。”	题干说的是 **all instances of graffiti cannot be removed in the same way**。C 段明确解释原因：**不同地点情况不同**，所以不能一刀切。这里的 **no one treatment suitable for all situations** 就是题干的直接对应。
16	**B**	论证涂鸦会对**社区生活**产生负面影响	**“...graffiti can lead to more serious forms of vandalism and, ultimately, to the deterioration of a neighborhood area, and in this way contributes to a general social decline.”**	“涂鸦会导致更严重的破坏行为，并最终导致社区区域恶化，从而促成整体社会衰退。”	题干中的 **negative effect on community life** 对应原文的 **deterioration of a neighborhood area** 和 **general social decline**。这是在说它伤害社区环境和社会生活，因此答案是 **B 段**。
17	**E**	承认某些应对涂鸦的策略**可能反而导致涂鸦增加**	**“...physical obstacles such as fences, railings, doors, or gates can be introduced to discourage unauthorized access, though in some cases, these obstacles simply provide a new surface for graffiti.”**	“可以设置围栏、栏杆、门或大门等实体障碍来阻止未经授权的进入，不过在某些情况下，这些障碍物反而只是提供了新的涂鸦表面。”	题干核心是 **may lead to an increase in graffiti**。E 段最后一句承认：本来是防止涂鸦的障碍物，结果可能成了**新的涂鸦表面**。这正是“某些策略反而适得其反”。
18	**D**	清除涂鸦时人们会面临的一些风险	**“...care must be taken with regard to protecting both passers-by and the person carrying out the graffiti removal.”；“... avoid the drifting of aerial mists.”；“...avoid being hurt by hard airborne particles.”**	“必须注意保护路人和实施清除的人。”；“要避免空气中雾状物飘散。”；“以免被坚硬的空气传播颗粒伤到。”	题干是 **risks people face when graffiti is being removed**。D 段专门讲清除时的安全问题：化学法会有有害化学物、漂浮雾滴；机械法会有硬颗粒飞散伤人。所以答案是 **D 段**。

Questions 19–20

选择题（选 TWO）

题号	答案	题干翻译	精确定位句	定位句翻译	详细解释
19	**B**	文章给出了关于不同涂鸦清除方法的细节。以下哪两点是作者提出的?	**“These trials should be carried out on a small unobtrusive area if possible ...”**	“如果可能的话，这些试验应在一个不起眼的小区域进行……”	B 项 **An inconspicuous part of a surface should be used to test a cleaning method** 与原文 **small unobtrusive area** 完全对应。**inconspicuous = unobtrusive**，都是“不显眼的”。所以 **B 正确**。
20	**D**	同上	**“...take measures to minimize any run-off of potentially harmful chemicals, and avoid the drifting of aerial mists.”**	“要采取措施将潜在有害化学物的流出降到最低，并避免空气中雾状物飘散。”	D 项 **Localised pollution can result from some cleaning methods** 对应的是化学清除法可能造成**化学物流出**和**雾状物飘散**，本质上就是局部污染/局部环境危害。所以 **D 正确**。

其余选项为什么错?

- **A Chemicals are an expensive method ...**
  文中没有说化学法“昂贵”。提到“cost too high”的是 **保护措施**（比如灯光、监控、障碍物），不是化学清除法本身。
- **C Alcohol-based chemical preparations ...**
  文中只说 chemical preparations / solvents，从温和到危险的“chemical cocktails”，**没有说是酒精类**，也没有说“经常成功”。
- **E It is best to use the strongest available cleaning method.**
  原文正好相反：**“always start with the least aggressive cleaning method”**，先用最温和的方法，通常是水。

Questions 21–22

选择题（选 TWO）

题号	答案	题干翻译	精确定位句	定位句翻译	详细解释
21	D	作者提到了哪些应对反复出现的涂鸦问题的方法?	**“Possible protection measures may include a combination of floodlighting to illuminate dark areas and surveillance systems such as closed-circuit television.”**	“可能的保护措施包括结合使用泛光照明来照亮黑暗区域，以及闭路电视等监控系统。”	D项 **Ensuring surfaces are visible and monitored both day and night** 对应“照亮黑暗区域 + 监控系统”。虽然原文没逐字写 **day and night**，但“照亮黑暗区域”明显针对夜间，“surveillance”表示持续监控，因此这是合理对应。
22	E	同上	**“Another strategy is to apply a removable anti-graffiti barrier-coating ... leaving a thin veneer that essentially serves to isolate the graffiti from the surface.”**	“另一种策略是涂上一层可移除的防涂鸦隔离涂层……留下一层薄薄的覆盖层，其本质作用是把涂鸦与表面隔开。”	E项 **Adding a covering layer that graffiti cannot penetrate** 对应 barrier-coating。原文意思是：表面先加一层隔离层，涂鸦附着在这层上，而不是直接进入原表面。虽然题目说“cannot penetrate”是概括表达，但和 **isolate the graffiti from the surface** 是吻合的。

其余选项为什么错?

- **A Running advertising campaigns against graffiti**
  文中没提宣传活动。
- **B Creating a new building material that repels graffiti**
  文中说的是给现有表面加一层 **barrier-coating**，不是“发明新的建筑材料”。
- **C Hiring security guards and increasing police patrols**
  文中提到的是 **CCTV**、**照明**、**障碍物**，没有说增加保安或巡逻。

Questions 23–26

句子填空题

题号	答案	题干翻译	精确定位句	定位句翻译	详细解释
23	**social history**	古代涂鸦之所以被研究，是因为它记录了那个时期文化的一个_____。	**“...it provides a social history of life and events at that time.”**	“……因为它提供了当时生活和事件的社会史。”	题干中的 **records a ___ of the culture of that period** 对应原文 **provides a social history**。答案直接取原文 **social history**。而且符合字数要求，不超过两词。
24	**tag**	涂鸦者独特的签名，被称为_____，可以帮助警方找到并起诉他们。	**“An incidence pattern can help to identify possible culprits, as can their ‘tag’—the distinctive mark graffitists leave to show the graffiti is their work.”**	“事件发生的模式可以帮助识别可能的肇事者，涂鸦者的‘标签’也可以——那是他们留下的独特标记，用来表明该涂鸦是他们的作品。”	题干说 **The unique signature of graffitists**，原文明确解释这个独特标记叫 **tag**。这是原词重现。
25	**protective clothing**	使用化学和机械两种涂鸦清除系统的操作人员都必须有_____。	**“When using chemicals, it is important to wear protective clothing ...”；“Operators of mechanical systems must also wear protective clothing ...”**	“使用化学品时，穿防护服很重要……”；“机械系统的操作人员也必须穿防护服……”	题干中的 **operators of both ... systems** 对应D段两处共同要求：两类操作人员都要穿 **protective clothing**。答案不能写 clothing 或 protection，最准确完整的是原文短语。
26	**water**	经过隔离涂层处理的表面通常可以用_____来清洁。	**“...it will make its removal much easier and usually only involves using water ...”**	“……这会让其清除容易得多，而且通常只需要用水。”	F段明确说 barrier-coating 后，清除通常只需 **water**。答案直接来自原文。